

IRAN

Iran: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Islamic Republic of Iran
Short Form	Iran
Capital	Tehran
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Theocratic Republic
Supreme Leader	Ayatollah Ali Khamenei (as of 2025)
President	Ebrahim Raisi (as of 2025)
Currency	Iranian Rial (IRR)
UN Member Since	24 October 1945
Permanent UNSC Member	No
MUN Standing	Regional power in Middle East, significant oil exporter, controversial nuclear program, strong advocate of sovereignty and anti-Western influence policies

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
Reading Iran: The Illusion of Power	Misagh Parsa	Detailed analysis of Iran's domestic and international politics
Iran and the United Nations: A Study in Conflict and Cooperation	Shirin Tahir-Kheli	Iran's interaction with the UN
The Nuclear Sphinx of Tehran: Mahmoud Ahmadinejad and the State of Iran	Youssef M. Ibrahim	Insights on Iran's nuclear policy

Guardians of the Revolution: Iran and the World in the Age of the Ayatollahs	Ray Takeyh	History and foreign policy of modern Iran
Human Rights in Iran: The Abuse of Cultural Relativism	Mahmood Amiry-Moghaddam	Iran's human rights record analysis

Research Table: Iran & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UN Web TV – 58th HRC Session (Feb–Apr 2025)	UN Web TV: 34th Meeting – HRC58	Visual records of debates, including Iran's item(s)—essential for reviewing state statements and Council dynamics. (webtv.un.org , webtv.un.org)
USCIRF – 2025 Annual Report (PDF)	Iran 2025 USCIRF Report	Independent U.S. government analysis on Iran's religious freedom shortcomings—useful in multilateral rights debates.
VICE News Documentary – Inside Iran Uprising	Inside Iran: Protest Aftermath	On-the-ground footage of the “Woman, Life, Freedom” protests—vivid primary source for HRC dialogues on civil and political rights.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Iran Country Profile	OHCHR Iran	Official UN overview of Iran's treaty obligations, human rights mechanisms, and OHCHR presence—foundational for all research. (ohchr.org)
UNHRC – Situation Report (Mar 2025)	A/HRC/58/62 PDF	Recent in-depth examination of gender-specific violations, executions, and crackdown on dissent.
UN UPR Compilation	UN UPR Compilation	Consolidated submissions and recommendations from UPR cycles—essential for state accountability tracking.
HRW – Expanded FFMI (Apr 2025)	UN Expands Investigations	Confirms UNHRC's mandate extension to a Fact-Finding Mission on Iran—key global accountability mechanism.

Amnesty International – Country Page	Amnesty Iran	Provides updates on executions, political repression, women's rights and more—important civil rights perspective.
UN Treaty Body Database – Iran	UN Treaty Ratifications	Shows which UN human rights protocols Iran has signed or ratified—critical for legal analysis.
FFMI – OHCHR Special Procedures	Fact-Finding Mission on Iran	Official FFM site documenting its mandate, objectives, and methods—core UNHRC initiative.
UPR National Report 2019 (PDF)	Iran UPR Report 2019	Government transparency around UPR recommendations—from Iran's perspective.
HRW – NGO Statement for Mandate Renewal	Joint NGO Statement Mar 2024	Civil society urging UNHRC to renew the special rapporteur and FFM—shows advocacy pressures.
Amnesty – FFMI Expansion	Amnesty Urges Mandate Expansion	Amnesty's analysis of the FFMI extension and impact.
OHCHR Press – Rapporteur's First Report (Mar 2025)	Special Rapporteur's First Report	Insight into recent findings on execution surge, transparency issues, women's rights.
IOM – Iran Crisis Plan 2024–25	IOM Crisis Response Plan PDF	Details protection, displacement, and migration issues—touches on UNHRC migration agenda.
US State Dept 2022 HR Report	Iran 2022 Human Rights Report	Covers civil/political rights, labor, migrants, due process—comprehensive discussion.
UN Data – HRC Documents on Iran	HRC Documents Portal	Centralized official records of UNHRC actions and resolutions.
Impact Iran – Joint Statement Apr 2025	HRC Decision Celebrated	Regional NGO coalition praises UNHRC action—shows stakeholder momentum.
Amnesty – Civil Rights Submission (2024)	Amnesty UPR Submission 2024	Details crackdown on expression, assembly, and NGO activity—relevant to civil & political rights.
UN Charter Committee – Iran Statement (PDF)	Iran's Sanctions Statement	Iran's diplomatic arguments on sanctions presented to UN General Assembly—touches on coercive measures agenda.

UNFF Report on Business & HR	Business & Human Rights WG Report	Reviews business responsibilities and human rights due diligence in Iran.
Security Council Report – Resolution 22/23 (PDF)	HRC Resolution on Iran	HRC resolution expressing concern over violations and urging technical cooperation.
State Dept 2023 HR Report (PDF)	Iran 2023 Report	Updates on mass detentions, protests, political rights—most recent full annual review.
FIDH – UPR Report 2024	FIDH UPR 2024 Iran	NGO review highlighting deteriorating conditions since 2019—key UPR input.
HRW – Renew Mandates (Mar 2025)	HRW Urges UN Action	Press statement urging continuation of UNHRC monitoring—shows NGO diplomacy.
Fact-Finding Mission Q&A Video	FFMI Experts Q&A	HRC58 WebTV video explaining FFMI goals and process—useful visual resource.
Amnesty – Joint Letter 2025	Iran NGOs Call for Rapporteur	Coalition advocacy for mandate renewal during HRC58.

Unique Aspects of Iran's UNHRC Context

- Fact-Finding Mission in Place:** Iran stands out as one of the rare states under the UN Human Rights Council that is currently facing an independent Fact-Finding Mission. This sets a significant legal precedent for accountability.
- Special Rapporteur with Renewed Mandate:** The HRC brought back a special rapporteur for 2024–25, showing that international attention is still very much focused on this issue.
- Mass Executions & Death Penalty:** Iran is at the forefront of global execution statistics, with more than 850 executions recorded in 2023 alone. This alarming trend has made death penalty reform a key issue for the Human Rights Council.
- Post-Mahsa Amini Rights Crisis:** The “Woman, Life, Freedom” protests from 2022 to 2025 led to a significant crackdown on rights, which has become a key focus of recent investigations by the Human Rights Council.

5. **Expanded Human Rights Scope:** The HRC resolution now addresses crimes against humanity, as well as issues affecting women, minorities, and arbitrary detention—highlighting the complex nature of these violations.
 6. **Business & Labor due-diligence scrutiny:** Iran is currently looking into trials that focus on corporate involvement and the exploitation of migrant labor, as part of the UN Working Group on Business and Human Rights.
 7. **Governmental UPR Follow-up Reports:** Iran consistently provides updates on its national UPR progress, demonstrating a commitment to formal reporting.
 8. **International NGO Coalitions:** Organizations such as HRW, Amnesty, FIDH, and others work together to coordinate their statements at the HRC, showcasing the power of cross-border advocacy.
 9. **Arbitrary Detention of Dual Nationals:** The Iranian strategy of using foreign citizens as bargaining chips is attracting significant attention from the Human Rights Council and the diplomatic community.
 10. **Sanctions as Human Rights Concern:** Iran views unilateral sanctions as violations of human rights, and this perspective has been a steady part of its diplomatic approach at both the UN General Assembly and the Human Rights Council.
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